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DESTINATION HIRING

In the first half of 2020, there were many reports of mass layoffs in the IT sector, particularly when it came to the contract workers. As things bounce back to normal, the hiring is expected to increase again, in the first few months of 2021. Naren Krishna, Head of Careers at InterviewBit & Scaler Academy explains, “The pandemic has certainly impacted businesses across sectors which resulted in lay-offs and freeze in new hiring. However, as businesses have adapted to the new normal and are bouncing back gradually, the job markets are showing healthy signs of recovery. In fact, our placement numbers validate this fact as well. Though we witnessed a major dip in hiring activity during Q2 of 2020, we have witnessed significant recovery by the end of Q3, 2020. From recent interactions with our hiring partners from across sectors, we are optimistic about hiring and are confident that it will pick up momentum by Q1 2021. The major sectors which will be the key drivers of job market would undoubtedly be high-growth startups, Financial GIC's & IT/ITes. From skills perspective, Java & Full-stack skills continue to be major skill requirements by most of the startups & product based companies. Further, the pandemic has pushed companies to adapt to completely digital and virtual recruitment, on-boarding and engagement model, with a significant focus on recruitment cost reduction. At Scaler, we are fairly optimistic that our placement rate will increase by over 100% in the first half of 2021.”

The major IT players in India, including Wipro, Infosys and TCS adapted rapidly and enthusiastically to a shift towards working from home. In fact, Infosys has announced plans for a flexible and hybrid work model next year, where employees will be able to work from home as much as they want to, and are given a choice to either work from office or

from home. TCS, Wipro and Infosys went even further and announced plans to make 98 per cent of their work force work from home, at least till the end of next year. The pandemic also reversed one of the long running trends in the IT services sector, that of outsourcing. As a result of the pandemic, there is now more confidence in the ability to manage operations from anywhere in the world, giving rise to the trend of destination hiring.

Anshul Sushil, CEO & Co-Founder at Wizikey explains, with mass layoffs and intense pay cuts making headlines in the first half of the year, the Indian IT industry definitely has gone through its own share of headwinds. It has taken time for them

services all the way till 2024. One of the driving factors in accelerating cloud adoption will be improvements in automation technologies for cloud migrations. In fact, adoption of cloud services is expected to proceed at twice the rate as before the pandemic. Richard L Villars, group vice president, Worldwide Research at IDC says, “Cloud in all its permutations – hardware/software/services/ as a service as well as public/private/ hybrid/multi/edge – will play ever greater, and even dominant, roles across the IT industry for the foreseeable future. By the end of 2021, based on lessons learned in the pandemic, most enterprises will put a mechanism in place to accelerate their shift to cloud-centric digital infrastructure



Credit: Infosys

An Infosys shuttle taking employees to work during the pandemic

to adopt to the new normal. By diving through news via our analytics tools, we deciphered that destination hiring and remote working are the top emerging trends in the industry.”

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ACCELERATING CLOUDIFICATION

The pandemic led to a rise in adoption of cloud technologies by enterprises throughout 2020, particularly when it came to SAAS services. Going forward, the adoption of cloud technologies is only expected to increase. The International Data Corporation, in a report called Worldwide Whole Cloud Forecast, 2020-2024 forecasts a double digit compound growth rate for cloud

and application services twice as fast as before the pandemic.”

The research findings from Gartner too suggest an increase in cloud adoption going into 2021, with 70 per cent of the organisations using cloud services planning to increase their spendings to address the disruptions caused by the pandemic. Mobility, collaboration and remote working tools are the major requirements for workforces that organisations need to build capacity for. Sid Nag, Research Vice-President at Gartner says, “The pandemic validated cloud’s value proposition. The ability to use on-demand, scalable cloud models to achieve cost efficiency and business continuity is providing the impetus for organisations to rapidly accelerate their digital business transformation